

HI

FILM MAKING REPORT

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BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

Certified that this Report titled “HI – SHORT FILM ANALYSIS & PRODUCTION REPORT” is the bonafide work of VELVIZHI . P (231701061). The project was carried out under my supervision and guidance. The report is based on the short film “HI”. The film belongs to the Psychological Horror / Mystery / Suspense genre. The approximate running time of the film is 2 minutes 59 seconds. The project demonstrates concepts of story development and screenplay. It also includes cinematography, lighting, sound design and editing. The work has not been submitted for any other degree or award. This report is submitted as part of the project's requirements.

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ABSTRACT

The short film “HI” is a psychological horror, mystery and suspense film with an approximate running time of 3 minutes . The film presents an ordinary evening at home that gradually turns into an unsettling and mysterious experience. The story focuses on a young woman whose normal routine changes as she encounters unusual situations involving her phone, surroundings and the spaces within her home. The film uses visual storytelling, cinematography, lighting, sound design, editing and character movement to create suspense and maintain audience curiosity. The familiar home setting is transformed into an uncertain environment through darkness, shadows, doors and carefully selected camera angles. The film avoids excessive dialogue and instead communicates the story through actions, expressions and visual clues. The central theme of the film is fear created by isolation and uncertainty. The ending with the simple greeting “HI” provides an unexpected and open conclusion, allowing viewers to form their own interpretation of the events. Overall, the project demonstrates how a simple location, limited characters and effective filmmaking techniques can be used to create an engaging short film.

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HI

SHORT FILM ANALYSIS & PRODUCTION REPORT

Film format: Short film

Approximate running time: 2 minutes 59 seconds

Genre: Psychological Horror / Mystery / Suspense

Central idea: An ordinary evening at home slowly turns into an unsettling encounter.

One-Line Story

A young woman spending time alone at home begins to experience a series of unsettling signs after interacting with her phone, turning an ordinary night into a mysterious encounter that ends with a disturbing greeting: “HI.”

Moral

Fear can grow when we are isolated and uncertain; staying aware of our surroundings and communicating with trusted people can help us respond to unexpected situations.

Note on interpretation: This report is based on the visible events, staging, objects, lighting, character movement and ending shown in the uploaded video. Where the film deliberately leaves events unexplained, the report treats those points as suspense or interpretation rather than stating an uncertain explanation as fact.

1. Introduction

The short film “HI” is a psychological horror, mystery and suspense film with an approximate running time of 3 minutes . The story takes place mainly in a familiar home setting, where an ordinary evening gradually turns into an unsettling experience.

The film follows a young woman as she goes through her daily activities and interacts with her phone and surroundings. As the story progresses, unusual events, darkness, shadows and isolated spaces create a sense of fear and uncertainty. The familiar home slowly changes from a comfortable place into an environment filled with suspense.

The film mainly depends on visual storytelling rather than lengthy dialogue. Camera angles, lighting, character expressions, sound effects, editing and the use of everyday objects help communicate the story and build tension. The phone, doors and dark spaces also play an important role in creating curiosity among the viewers.

The ending with the simple word “HI” adds a mysterious and unexpected final moment. It leaves certain events unexplained and allows the audience to develop their own interpretation of what happened.

This report presents an analysis of the film’s story, genre, characters, setting, cinematography, lighting, sound design, editing, production design, themes and overall filmmaking techniques used to create suspense within a short duration.

2. One-Line Story, Logline and Tagline

A young woman spending an ordinary evening alone at home begins to notice a series of unusual and unexplained disturbances. As she moves through the familiar spaces of her house, her surroundings gradually become darker and more unsettling. Her interaction with her phone and the strange changes around her increase her curiosity and fear. What initially appears to be a normal evening slowly develops into a mysterious encounter, finally ending with the unexpected and disturbing greeting **“HI.”**

Logline

A young woman enjoys a quiet evening at home when a series of unexplained events begin to disturb her normal routine. As she becomes increasingly aware of strange sounds, dark spaces, objects and changes in her surroundings, she starts to feel that she may not be completely alone. The growing uncertainty makes her more cautious as she moves through the house. The appearance of another presence adds a new dimension to the situation and makes the audience reconsider the events that came before. The story concludes with the simple word **“HI,”** leaving the mystery partially unexplained and allowing the audience to create their own interpretation.

Tagline

“Sometimes the simplest greeting is the one that scares you.”

The tagline represents the central idea of the film. The word “HI” is normally associated with a friendly and harmless greeting, but within the context of the film it becomes mysterious and unsettling. This contrast between an ordinary word and a suspenseful situation creates curiosity and makes the ending memorable.

Core Conflict

The central conflict of the film is between the protagonist’s feeling of safety and the growing possibility that something unexpected is happening inside or around her home. The house initially represents comfort, familiarity and security. However, as the story progresses, the same environment begins to feel uncertain and threatening.

The protagonist is also faced with a lack of information. She does not immediately understand what is happening, and the audience is given limited information as well. This creates psychological tension because both the character and the viewer are trying to understand the situation. The conflict is therefore based not only on an external disturbance but also on **fear, uncertainty and the unknown.**

Story Question

The main question of the film is:

“What is really happening inside the seemingly ordinary home, and why does the film end with ‘HI’?”

The film intentionally does not provide a complete explanation. This allows the audience to consider different possibilities and interpret the ending according to their own understanding. The unanswered question becomes an important part of the suspense and encourages viewers to think about the film even after it ends.

Central Idea

The central idea of **“HI”** is that an ordinary and familiar environment can suddenly become frightening when uncertainty enters the situation. Through a simple domestic setting, a small number of characters and carefully planned visual and sound elements, the film creates suspense and curiosity within a short duration.

3. Genre

The short film “**HI**” is best classified as a **Psychological Horror / Mystery / Suspense** film. The story creates fear and tension through atmosphere, uncertainty, darkness and the reactions of the main character rather than relying on graphic violence.

Psychological Horror

The psychological horror element comes from the protagonist being alone in a familiar home environment that gradually begins to feel strange and uncomfortable. Darkness, isolation, unusual events and the character’s reactions create a feeling of fear and uncertainty. The audience is encouraged to imagine what may be present outside the visible frame.

Mystery

The film contains several unexplained events involving the **phone, different rooms, dark spaces and another character**. These details are not fully explained, allowing the audience to connect the clues and develop their own interpretation. The final “**HI**” adds to the mystery and leaves the ending open.

Suspense

Suspense is created through the gradual development of the story. The film begins with an ordinary evening and slowly introduces unusual situations. **Camera angles, lighting, silence, sound, character movement and pacing** increase the audience’s anticipation. The viewer expects something to happen but is unsure of what will happen next.

Domestic / Contained Horror

The film can also be described as a **domestic or contained horror** because most of the story takes place inside a home. The familiar setting initially represents comfort and safety, but gradually becomes a place of uncertainty and suspense.

Overall Classification

Therefore, “**HI**” can be academically presented as a **short psychological suspense-horror film with mystery elements and an ambiguous ending**. The film demonstrates how simple locations, limited characters and effective filmmaking techniques can create suspense within a short duration.

4. Moral and Message

The main moral of the short film “HI” is that **when something feels unusual or uncertain, awareness and communication are important. Facing fear and uncertainty alone can make a situation feel more frightening.**

The film also reminds us that familiar places are not always perceived in the same way. A home usually represents comfort, safety and peace, but the film gradually changes this feeling through darkness, silence, unusual events and suspenseful situations. This change shows how our perception of a familiar environment can be affected by fear and uncertainty.

The important messages conveyed through the film are:

- **Be aware of your surroundings** and pay attention when something feels unusual.
- **Communication is important** when dealing with uncertainty or unexpected situations.
- **Fear can become stronger when we do not understand what is happening.**
- **Familiar places can appear different** when our emotions and perceptions change.
- **Uncertainty creates suspense**, because the audience does not know what will happen next.
- **Not everything needs to be explained immediately.** The open ending allows viewers to think and create their own interpretation.
- The film shows that even a **simple greeting such as “HI”** can become meaningful and unsettling when placed in the right context.

Overall, the film uses a simple story to communicate the importance of **awareness, communication and understanding** while showing how fear can develop from uncertainty and the unknown.

5. Story Synopsis

The short film “HI” begins with an exterior view of a residential area, establishing a normal and familiar environment. The opening creates a peaceful atmosphere and introduces the location before the story moves inside the house. The main female character is shown in her home, carrying out ordinary activities as part of her daily routine.

As the story progresses, the phone becomes an important visual element. The character interacts with her phone and screen, creating a connection between digital communication and the events that gradually unfold. However, the film does not immediately explain the importance of the information or communication, allowing the audience to remain curious.

The protagonist continues her normal activities inside the house, including spending time in the living area and handling food in the kitchen. Ordinary household objects such as a knife, chopping board, food items and furniture are shown through different camera angles. These objects initially appear normal, but their importance increases as the atmosphere of the film becomes more suspenseful.

As the character moves between different rooms, the lighting gradually becomes darker. The familiar home begins to feel less comfortable and more mysterious. Doors, corridors, shadows and empty spaces are used to create suspense. The protagonist becomes more cautious and appears increasingly aware of her surroundings, making the audience wonder whether someone or something else may be present.

The change in lighting and camera framing helps show the transition from an ordinary evening to an unsettling situation. Instead of clearly revealing the source of the disturbance, the film keeps certain details hidden. This creates suspense by allowing the audience to imagine possible explanations.

A second female character eventually appears, creating a change in the mood and rhythm of the story. Her appearance provides new information but does not completely explain the events that occurred earlier. The interaction between the characters adds another layer to the mystery.

Towards the end, the atmosphere becomes relatively brighter and calmer. However, the film concludes with the simple word “HI.” This unexpected ending creates a final sense of mystery and encourages the audience to think about the meaning of the events they have witnessed.

Overall, the narrative of “HI” depends more on visual storytelling, atmosphere, anticipation and suspense than on lengthy dialogue. The film uses a simple domestic setting and a small number of characters to create an engaging mystery that remains open to interpretation.

6. Plot Structure

The short film “HI” follows a simple but effective plot structure that gradually develops from an ordinary situation into a mysterious and suspenseful experience. Since the film has a short running time, the story focuses on important visual moments rather than detailed backstory or lengthy dialogue.

Beginning – Setup

The film begins by introducing the protagonist in a familiar home environment. The exterior and interior shots establish the location and create a sense of normality. The protagonist is shown carrying out her usual activities, while her phone and other household objects are introduced as important visual elements. At this stage, there is no obvious indication of danger, allowing the audience to become comfortable with the setting.

Middle – Development

As the story moves forward, small details begin to create a feeling of discomfort. The protagonist continues moving through different areas of the house, but the atmosphere slowly changes. Her interaction with the phone and her surroundings becomes more noticeable. The lighting becomes darker, and the audience begins to feel that something unusual may be happening.

Rising Suspense

The suspense gradually increases through the use of silence, darkness, doors, shadows, empty spaces and isolated camera framing. The protagonist becomes more cautious and aware of her surroundings. Instead of showing everything clearly, the film hides certain details, allowing the audience to imagine what might be happening. This limited information creates curiosity and anticipation.

Turning Point

The appearance of the second female character creates a significant change in the story. Her presence changes the emotional atmosphere and gives the audience another way to interpret the events that occurred earlier. However, the film still does not provide a complete explanation, keeping the mystery alive.

Ending

The film concludes with the simple and unexpected word “HI.” This acts as the final dramatic beat of the story. Rather than clearly explaining the mystery, the ending leaves the audience with a question about the meaning of the greeting and the events that came before it.

Overall Structure

The plot follows a clear progression of normality → unusual events → rising suspense → turning point → mysterious ending. This structure is effective for a short film because it creates tension without requiring extensive background information. The limited duration is used efficiently to establish the characters, develop the atmosphere and provide a memorable final hook.

7. Character Analysis

The short film “HI” uses a small number of characters to keep the story focused and maintain the suspense. Since the film has a short running time, each character has a specific purpose in developing the atmosphere, story and mystery. The limited cast also makes the home environment feel more contained and personal.

Protagonist – Young Woman

The young woman is the central character and the main visual focus of the film. Most of the story is experienced through her actions, expressions and movement within the house. At the beginning, she appears comfortable and involved in normal household activities. Her behaviour gradually changes as she begins to notice unusual details around her.

Her expressions and body language become important in communicating her emotions without requiring lengthy dialogue. As she moves through different rooms, looks towards doors or enters darker areas, her actions create a feeling of curiosity and caution. The audience is encouraged to observe the environment from her point of view and share her uncertainty.

The protagonist also helps create the emotional connection between the audience and the story. Because the viewers follow her throughout most of the film, her reactions guide the audience's response to the mysterious events. Her transition from normal behaviour to increased awareness helps build the suspense.

Second Female Character

A second female character appears during the later part of the film. Her appearance creates a noticeable change in the story and introduces another element to the narrative. Her exact relationship with the protagonist is not heavily explained, allowing the audience to interpret her role based on the events shown.

She may be understood as a friend, family member, visitor or another important narrative element. Her presence provides a contrast to the protagonist's earlier isolation and changes the mood of the film. The interaction between the two characters also helps move the story towards its final mysterious moment.

Unseen or Implied Presence

The film also creates the suggestion of an unseen or implied presence. Although this presence may not always be directly shown, it is suggested through darkness, empty spaces, doorways, camera framing and the protagonist's reactions. This technique is commonly effective in suspense filmmaking because the audience uses its imagination to understand what might be outside the frame.

The unseen presence therefore becomes an important part of the film's mystery. Instead of showing everything directly, the filmmaker allows the audience to imagine possible explanations.

Overall Character Design

The small cast is suitable for the short-film format because it keeps the narrative simple and focused. The protagonist carries most of the emotional development, while the second character and implied presence contribute to the mystery and suspense. Together, these elements support the film's central theme of fear, uncertainty and the unknown.

8. Setting and Location

The home is the primary setting. It includes a living area, kitchen/dining area, bedroom and connecting spaces. The repeated use of the same rooms gives the film a contained atmosphere.

The setting serves two opposite functions. At the beginning it represents familiarity and routine. Later, the same corridors, doors and dark corners become sources of uncertainty. This transformation is one of the film's main visual strengths.

The exterior view at the opening establishes the residential environment before the story becomes interior-focused. This provides context without requiring dialogue.

The house also reduces production requirements. A short film can be made effectively in one main location when the filmmaker changes lighting, camera angle, sound and blocking to make the location feel different from scene to scene.

9. Cinematography

Cinematography is central to the film's mood. The camera frequently observes the character from a distance or from angles that allow empty space to remain visible. In suspense filmmaking, empty space can become important because the audience wonders whether something will enter the frame.

The film uses a mixture of wider shots and closer views of objects. Wide shots establish the room and the character's isolation, while close-ups of the phone and household objects direct attention toward potentially meaningful details.

The darker sections use low-key lighting. This reduces visible information and increases uncertainty. The film allows parts of the frame to remain ambiguous, which is effective in suspense because the viewer's imagination completes the hidden information.

Useful cinematographic techniques visible in the film:

- Establishing shots
- Medium shots for character action
- Close-ups of important objects
- Dark doorway and corridor framing
- Negative space around the protagonist
- Slow or controlled camera movement to build anticipation

10. Lighting and Colour

Lighting is one of the clearest tools used to establish genre. Early scenes contain warm domestic lighting, while later sequences become much darker. This transition mirrors the emotional change from routine to uncertainty.

Low light can hide background information. Instead of showing the audience exactly what is in every corner, the filmmaker allows parts of the frame to remain ambiguous. This is especially effective in a suspense film because the viewer's imagination completes the hidden information.

The brighter appearance of the later interaction with the second character functions as a visual reset. It reduces the oppressive feeling of the earlier darkness and can make the audience question whether the danger has passed.

The lighting therefore does not simply illuminate the actors; it actively communicates the emotional state of the story.

11. Sound and Music

Sound is especially important in a short horror film because silence can be as powerful as music. The visual material suggests that the filmmaker uses quiet domestic moments and changes in atmosphere to create anticipation.

A strong sound design for this story includes room tone, footsteps, doors, phone sounds, kitchen sounds and carefully timed pauses. These ordinary sounds become meaningful when the audience expects something unusual.

Music, when used, should support rather than overpower the scene. A low, sustained texture can increase tension, while sudden reduction in sound can make the audience focus on a small movement or object.

Recommended sound approach for this film:

- Keep dialogue natural and limited.
- Use phone notification sounds as narrative cues.
- Allow short moments of silence before important reveals.
- Emphasize footsteps and door movement during suspense scenes.
- Use a restrained final sound cue before or during the “HI” ending.

12. Editing and Pacing

The film's short duration requires economical editing. Every shot must either establish the situation, build tension, provide information or prepare the ending.

The early section can use longer shots to communicate normality. As suspense develops, the editor can increase the number of cuts or alternate between the protagonist and details in the environment.

The placement of the phone and household objects is important because an object shown early can gain new significance later. This is a basic suspense technique: show the audience something before they understand why it matters.

The final transition to "HI" is particularly important. A simple title card or text can act as a punchline, reveal or unanswered question. Holding the final text on screen long enough gives the audience time to interpret it.

13. Props and Production Design

The film uses ordinary household props to support realism. The phone is particularly important because it connects the protagonist to information outside her immediate physical surroundings.

Kitchen items such as a chopping board and knife contribute to the realism of the domestic environment. Their presence also creates visual tension because familiar objects can look threatening when framed in a dark or suspenseful scene.

The bed, curtains, doors, television/screen and furniture establish the home as a lived-in space rather than a generic horror location.

Key props and motifs:

- Phone – communication, information and uncertainty.
- Doors – separation between known and unknown spaces.
- Kitchen objects – normal routine and visual tension.
- Bed/bedroom – vulnerability and personal space.
- Television/screen – an additional source of visual information.
- Final text “HI” – the closing mystery or narrative hook.

14. Themes and Symbolism

Isolation: The protagonist is repeatedly shown alone, making the home feel larger and less secure.

Communication: The phone suggests that information can arrive from outside the immediate environment. The final greeting also makes communication a possible thematic thread.

Familiarity becoming unfamiliar: The same home changes emotional meaning as lighting and behaviour change.

The unseen: Dark areas and off-screen spaces represent information the audience does not possess.

Ordinary versus extraordinary: The film begins with everyday actions and gradually introduces uncertainty. This contrast is a common and effective suspense technique.

The title “HI” is deliberately simple. Because the word is a normal greeting, placing it at the end of a suspense film can create an ironic contrast between an innocent word and an unsettling context.

15. Technical Analysis

Camera: The film benefits from stable compositions that allow the audience to inspect the environment. Selective close-ups guide attention to objects and reactions. With the help of iPhone 17 pro

Framing: Keeping empty areas in the frame creates anticipation. Doorways are particularly useful because they naturally divide visible and hidden space.

Blocking: The protagonist's movement from one room to another gives the film physical progression even when little dialogue is present.

Lighting: The change from warm domestic light to darker scenes creates an emotional progression.

Editing: The short runtime encourages concise visual storytelling and a strong final beat. With the help of VN and CapCut pro and Adobe After Effects

Sound: Everyday noises can be amplified in importance through silence and careful timing.

Together, these techniques demonstrate how a short film can create suspense without requiring a large cast, expensive locations or elaborate visual effects.

16. Production Plan

Cast: 2 principal performers are sufficient for the visible story.

Locations: One house/apartment with living area, kitchen/dining area, bedroom and corridor/doorway.

Equipment: Smartphone/camera, tripod or stabilizer, basic lighting source, reflector if available, and an external microphone if dialogue is important.

Props: Phone, food/kitchen items, chopping board, household furniture, bed/bedroom items and screen/television.

Lighting plan: Warm, natural-looking light for the beginning; progressively lower exposure and controlled practical light for suspense scenes; brighter light for the final interaction.

Sound plan: Record room tone separately. Capture clean phone notifications, footsteps, door sounds and dialogue. Avoid excessive background noise.

Editing plan: Assemble the normal-life section first, then gradually shorten shots as tension increases. Reserve the final few seconds for the “HI” reveal.

Safety: Any kitchen prop used for filming should be handled responsibly. If a knife is visible, it should be used only when necessary for the shot and handled safely.

17. Final Evaluation as a Short-Film Project

“HI” demonstrates a compact approach to filmmaking in which location, lighting and character behaviour carry much of the narrative. The story does not depend on a large cast or multiple locations. Instead, it transforms a familiar domestic environment into a space of uncertainty.

The film’s genre identity is strongest when the viewer is allowed to remain unsure about what is happening. Darkness and restricted information encourage the audience to participate in the storytelling by forming their own explanation.

For a college film project, the concept offers useful opportunities to demonstrate cinematography, editing, sound design, production design and acting. It also provides a clear basis for discussing how suspense can be created through visual language.

22. Conclusion

The short film “HI” is a psychological suspense-horror story built around isolation, ordinary domestic life and unexplained events. Its central strength is the contrast between the normality of the home and the increasingly uncomfortable atmosphere created within it.

The one-line story can therefore be summarized as: A young woman alone at home experiences a series of unexplained disturbances that turn an ordinary evening into a mysterious encounter, ending with the unsettling greeting “HI.”

Its genre can be described as Psychological Horror / Mystery / Suspense. Its central moral is that awareness and communication are important when a familiar situation suddenly feels uncertain or unsafe.

The final word “HI” gives the film a memorable closing image and leaves space for audience interpretation. Rather than explaining every detail, the ending invites the viewer to continue thinking about the story after the screen goes black.

Overall, the film demonstrates how a simple location and a small cast can support an effective short-film concept when visual storytelling, lighting, pacing and suspense are used together.

Appendix: Quick Reference

Title: HI

Format: Short film

Approximate duration: 2:59

Genre: Psychological Horror / Mystery / Suspense

One-line story: A young woman alone at home experiences unexplained disturbances that turn an ordinary evening into a mysterious encounter ending with “HI.”

Moral: Awareness and communication matter when an ordinary situation becomes uncertain.

Primary setting: House/apartment

Principal characters: Young woman/protagonist; second female character

Major motifs: Phone, doors, darkness, home, food/kitchen objects, final greeting

Key filmmaking techniques: Low-key lighting, close-ups, negative space, controlled pacing, domestic sound, visual ambiguity.

Overall message: Suspense can be created from ordinary life by changing the audience’s perception of familiar spaces and withholding information at carefully chosen moments.